



Environment variables

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Background

You can add environment variables, which are a type of binding, to attach text strings or JSON values to your Worker. Environment variables are available on the [env parameter](#) passed to your Worker's [fetch event handler](#).

Text strings and JSON values are not encrypted and are useful for storing application configuration.

Add environment variables via Wrangler

To add env variables using Wrangler, define text and JSON via the `[vars]` configuration in your Wrangler file. In the following example, `API_HOST` and `API_ACCOUNT_ID` are text values and `SERVICE_X_DATA` is a JSON value.

{} wrangler.jsonc wrangler.toml

```
{
  "name": "my-worker-dev",
  "vars": {
    "API_HOST": "example.com",
    "API_ACCOUNT_ID": "example_user",
    "SERVICE_X_DATA": {
      "URL": "service-x-api.dev.example",
      "MY_ID": 123
    }
  }
}
```

Refer to the following example on how to access the `API_HOST` environment variable in your Worker code:

JS JavaScript

TS TypeScript

```
export default {
  async fetch(request, env, ctx) {
    return new Response(`API host: ${env.API_HOST}`);
  },
};
```

Configuring different environments in Wrangler

[Environments in Wrangler](#) let you specify different configurations for the same Worker, including different values for vars in each environment. As vars is a [non-inheritable key](#), they are not inherited by environments and must be specified for each environment.

The example below sets up two environments, staging and production, with different values for `API_HOST`.

{ } wrangler.jsonc

⚙️ wrangler.toml

```
{
  "name": "my-worker-dev",
  "vars": {
    "API_HOST": "api.example.com"
  },
  "env": {
    "staging": {
      "vars": {
        "API_HOST": "staging.example.com"
      }
    },
    "production": {
      "vars": {
        "API_HOST": "production.example.com"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

To run Wrangler commands in specific environments, you can pass in the `--env` or `-e` flag. For example, you can develop the Worker in an environment called `staging` by running `npx wrangler dev --env staging`, and deploy it with `npx wrangler deploy --env staging`.

Learn about [environments in Wrangler](#).

Add environment variables via the dashboard

To add environment variables via the dashboard:

1. Log in to [Cloudflare dashboard](#) and select your account.
2. Select **Workers & Pages**.
3. In **Overview**, select your Worker.
4. Select **Settings**.
5. Under **Variables and Secrets**, select **Add**.

6. Select a **Type**, input a **Variable name**, and input its **Value**. This variable will be made available to your Worker.
7. (Optional) To add multiple environment variables, select **Add variable**.
8. Select **Deploy** to implement your changes.

Plaintext strings and secrets

Select the **Secret** type if your environment variable is a [secret](#). Alternatively, consider [Cloudflare Secrets Store](#), for account-level secrets.

Compare secrets and environment variables

Use secrets for sensitive information

Do not use plaintext environment variables to store sensitive information. Use [secrets](#) or [Secrets Store bindings](#) instead.

[Secrets](#) are [environment variables](#). The difference is secret values are not visible within Wrangler or Cloudflare dashboard after you define them. This means that sensitive data, including passwords or API tokens, should always be encrypted to prevent data leaks. To your Worker, there is no difference between an environment variable and a secret. The secret's value is passed through as defined.

When developing your Worker or Pages Function, create a `.dev.vars` file in the root of your project to define secrets that will be used when running `wrangler dev` or `wrangler pages dev`, as opposed to using environment variables in the [Wrangler configuration file](#). This works both in local and remote development modes.

The `.dev.vars` file should be formatted like a `dotenv` file, such as `KEY="VALUE"`:

`.dev.vars`

```
SECRET_KEY="value"
API_TOKEN="eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9"
```

To set different secrets for each environment, create files named `.dev.vars.<environment>`

name>. When you use `wrangler <command> --env <environment-name>`, the corresponding environment-specific file will be loaded instead of the `.dev.vars` file.

Like other environment variables, secrets are [non-inheritable](#) and must be defined per environment.

Related resources

- Migrating environment variables from [Service Worker format to ES modules syntax](#).

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